

Winning the first conversation

90 minutes including practice · 27 screens

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Your first-call reference

Use this after class alongside the presentation. Introduction, ALMS, channel choices, and examples are collected here. These fictional examples are adaptable wording, not scripts to recite.

The first conversation

Day 2 · Handling a Zillow Preferred lead with confidence

Learn the lead routes. Choose the right response. Guide the call with ALMS.

What we'll cover

Learn a piece, see an example, then try it.

- Recognize and respondRead the three lead routes. Choose a call, text, or requested callback. Vote and write your response.
- Guide the conversationIntroduce yourself, invite early, and use ALMS. Watch the examples, then practice discovery in pairs.
- Adapt and agree a planHandle questions and changed circumstances. Watch a full call, then rotate agent, buyer, and observer in trios.
- Follow throughRecord what matters, keep your promises, and leave with a first-call reference.

Use your signed-in learner session for votes and short answers. Submit first; then we compare reasoning and reveal the example.

Three lead routes

Read the lead's type and actual request before choosing your response.

Lead type	Buyer request	How it reaches you
Connection / contact agent	Contact about a home for sale	Live phone connection or FUB alert with contact preference
Real-time touring	A tour, using availability supplied through ShowingTime	FUB alert; not a live call in TRU's documented flow
Standard property tour	A tour at a requested time	Live connection or FUB alert; requested time may still need availability checks

Example: "I requested 4 p.m." on a standard tour is a requested time. "I'll check access and confirm with you" keeps the request moving without promising unverified access.

Choose the response that fits

Calls help you hear tone, ask follow-up questions, and build a relationship.

Already connected

Introduce yourself and help with the request. You are already on the call.

New alert, no preference

Call within five minutes of receipt during TRU's 8 a.m.-8 p.m. operating window. If unanswered, follow with a personal text.

Text first / requested callback

Acknowledge by text now; honor the requested call time or explicit no-call preference.

If the first call is unanswered

Make it easy for the buyer to recognize you and respond.

- Call promptlyPlace the call within five minutes of receipt in the normal flow. Leave an opening voicemail when appropriate.
- Follow with a personal textConnect to the real inquiry and invite a phone conversation with genuine availability.
- Keep ownershipContinue useful outreach while unanswered. The automated introduction is separate from your work.

Hi Jordan, this is Sam with Northside Realty. I just tried calling about your request to see 1234 Lane. I can talk at 4 or 6 today - does either work for you?

“Text now” and “call at five”

Acknowledge the buyer now while respecting the plan they requested.

“Text is better right now.”

“Of course. I can help here. A quick call would also let us talk through the home and your plans - would this evening work?” Text now; do not record a permanent no-call preference.

“Call me at five.”

“Hi Maya, I'm Sam with Northside Realty, the agent who'll call at five about your request. Let me know if you have questions before then.” Keep five unless the buyer agrees to change it.

“Please do not call me.”

Honor that request. Give useful help through the agreed channel.

ALMS is your call framework

Start with a clear introduction. Then help with the appointment before discovery.

A

Appointment

Make it easy to meet.

L

Location

Understand where and what fits.

M

Motivation

Learn why it matters.

S

Summarize

Confirm what happens next.

Location and motivation can flow in either order. Listen to the person; do not recite a checklist.

Take the first turn

Orient the buyer: your name, brokerage, Zillow connection, and reason for the conversation.

Hi Jordan, I'm Sam with Northside Realty, a featured partner with Zillow. I'm reaching out about your request to see 1234 Lane.

Live connection

"Zillow connected us about your request..." fits a buyer already on the line. Begin warmly instead of waiting in silence.

Outbound call

"I'm calling about your request..." connects an unfamiliar number to something the buyer recognizes.

Use your real brokerage and role. Do not borrow claims about expertise or relationships that are not yours.

Would Saturday morning or afternoon work better? I'll check access with the property.

Ask permission, then learn what fits

Explain why the questions will help the buyer.

Do you have a few minutes so I can learn what you're looking for and make our time together useful?

Location

What attracted you to this area? What makes that location work for you?

Follow the answer

If they mention a shorter commute, ask what would improve. Do not jump to the next checklist item.

M · Motivation

Move from the feature to the reason behind it.

Buyer "We really want a bigger yard."

Agent "What would you like to be able to do with that space?"

Buyer "I want room for a vegetable garden."

Agent "That helps. What would the garden need from the space?"

"Big yard" is a feature. Gardening gives it meaning. Do not assume dogs, children, entertaining, or any other reason.

S • Summarize

Give the buyer back their priorities and the agreed next step.

You're looking in this area because it works for your commute, and usable garden space matters most. We're aiming for Saturday morning. I'll confirm access to 1234 Lane and send the details. You're open to two nearby comparisons. Have I understood that correctly?

Name what is agreed, what still needs checking, and who will do it. Invite the buyer to correct you.

"I just have questions."

Help with the question; earn another invitation through useful service.

- Acknowledge and capture "Of course - what would you like to know?" Answer accurately; say what you need to check.
- Learn the context With permission, understand what drew them to the home and how the answer affects their search.
- Offer a useful next step Explain how seeing the home could help. If they still decline, stop pushing and agree how you'll bring back the answers.

Answers are not a reward for agreeing to a showing. Never guess or hide a known answer.

Keep the first meeting easy

Do not open with a demand for preapproval, budget, or proof they are ready to buy.

Why timing matters

They asked to see a home. A private financial interview from someone they do not know can turn that request into a barrier.

If the buyer asks

Answer their question. Learn enough context to make guidance useful; involve a lender for financing specifics.

The usual later opening

The end of the first showing offers context for a relevant financing conversation. A long buying timeline does not automatically rule out planning help.

Answer honestly and keep helping

Answer the role question clearly, then return to how you can help.

Your role

"I'm not the listing agent. I help buyers and can coordinate with the listing side. What would you like to know?"

Availability

If the home is under contract, say so. Check any uncertain access; do not promise a showing.

Useful next step

Ask what attracted them to the home and offer relevant options, with their permission.

One call, from the opening...

Fictional demonstration · use your own words and true availability.

Introduce “Hi Jordan, I’m Sam with Northside Realty, a featured partner with Zillow. I’m calling about 1234 Lane.”

Appointment “Would Saturday morning or afternoon work better? I’ll verify access.”

Permission “Have you got a few minutes so I can make our outing useful?”

Location “What attracted you to this area?”

Jordan: “It would shorten my commute.”

...to a clear next step

The next question comes from what the buyer says.

Motivation “What else caught your eye?”

Jordan: “The yard. I’d like a vegetable garden.”

“What would you need from that space?”

Plan “Would you like to compare a couple of other homes while we’re out?”

Summarize “The commute and garden space matter. Saturday morning is your preference. I’ll check access, research the comparisons, and send the details. Is that right?”

Then briefly explain the applicable touring form and the follow-up you are actually committing to.

Follow through on what you promised

The next contact should have a reason the buyer recognizes.

After a conversation

Record their priorities, contact preference, pending access checks, and the exact next action you promised.

If unanswered

Day one: aim for three to four personal touches, at least two calls and one text. First week: ten total including day one, mostly calls.

Once they reply

Follow the conversation and agreed plan. Stop applying the unanswered-lead quota.

Set a task for the promised action. Use the buyer’s agreed channel and timing; a reply ends the unanswered-lead quota, not your responsibility to follow through.

Keep this beside you

Introduction -> Appointment -> Location / Motivation -> Summarize

Before contact

Lead type · actual request · property · tour or callback time · contact preference

During the call

Orient them · offer the meeting · ask permission · follow an answer · propose useful comparisons

Before you finish

Restate priorities · distinguish confirmed from pending · explain the next step · record and follow through

Open your Day 2 reference and practice notes. Revisit any chapter whenever you need it.

Practice notes

Use fictional details. Write before the example, practice aloud, and retry one specific part after feedback. During a live session, submit through your own login; this printable worksheet is a backup and does not submit for you. Unfinished work remains available when the presenter advances.

VOTE · Read the request

A standard tour lead asks for 5 p.m. The property's availability is not confirmed. What do you do?

- Acknowledge 5 p.m. and verify property access.
- Tell them the showing is confirmed because they selected 5 p.m.
- Ignore 5 p.m. and ask when they want to tour.

Choose one, then explain your own response.

WRITE & DISCUSS · Choose your next message

Maya's alert arrives at 2 p.m. and asks for a 5 p.m. call. Write your acknowledgment.

What would you text Maya now?

VOTE · Now try the opening

Jordan asked to see 1234 Lane and has not requested a time. How would you begin?

- Introduce yourself and offer workable showing times.
- Start by asking for preapproval and budget.
- Explain the entire buying process first.

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Write your introduction and early appointment invitation.

BREAKOUT · Ask the next question

Pairs: one buyer says “We need more space.” Ask permission, learn what that means, and follow their answer. Switch roles.

What would you ask next, and what would that help you understand?

What did your partner suggest, and how did your retry change?

Observe the assigned learner and round:

- Ask permission before discovery
- Ask a follow-up based on the buyer’s actual answer

Observer / learner / round / one correction / retry:

WRITE & DISCUSS · Close this call

Jordan wants garden space, prefers Saturday morning, and is open to another home. Access is still unconfirmed.

Write the summary and next step you would say aloud.

VOTE · Respond to their question

The buyer asks, “Should I talk to a lender before we look?” What is the best response?

- Understand their timing and concern, then offer relevant guidance.
- Say financing can never be discussed on the first call.
- Require a preapproval letter before continuing.

Choose one, then explain your own response.

WRITE & DISCUSS · Keep helping with the inquiry

On the first call, Jordan asks about a home that is under contract. You learn garden space matters. What do you say?

Write your response and a useful next step.

BREAKOUT · Your turn: handle the whole call

Trios: agent, buyer, observer. Run the full first call using the buyer card, give one specific correction, retry, then rotate until everyone has spoken.

What did you learn about the buyer?

What will you improve?

What changed when you tried it again?

Observe the assigned learner and round:

- Clear name, brokerage, Zillow connection and purpose
- Useful early appointment invitation that respects the request
- Permission, relevant location/motivation questions and a follow-up
- Accurate priorities, commitments and unresolved checks
- Responds to the buyer's actual preference and circumstances

Observer / learner / round / one correction / retry:

WRITE & DISCUSS · Check your understanding

Without looking back, explain how you would handle the next lead.

What does ALMS stand for, and why does the appointment come early?

What changes when the buyer asks for a later call or text first?

Give one follow-up question that turns a feature into a reason.

Buyer practice cards

Jordan · a garden

I'd like to see 1234 Lane Saturday morning. The yard caught my eye.

Buyer: the reason is a vegetable garden; reveal it after a relevant question. Agent confirms what still needs checking.

Maya · text first

I'm at work. Please text me now; I can talk at five.

Begin with the text exchange, then fast-forward to the agreed call. Buyer: a shorter commute matters; reveal it when asked. Honor the current preference and agree the later conversation.

Alex · questions first

I only wanted to know about the roof. I'm not ready to book a showing.

Help with the question, learn context with permission, and respect a declined invitation. Buyer: you want to understand potential maintenance before deciding to tour.

What each signal means

Connection status is separate from participation. A submitted answer is separate from a completed action. A record check is separate from writing quality. Record who observed a speaking turn and who reviewed it; a peer observation or self-check is not coach sign-off. Practice readiness, quiz certification, and activation remain separate.

After the workshop

Live session: closing the session creates assignments for recall within 24 hours, a fresh case in three days, and coach review in seven days. The session creator owns follow-up across the selected teams unless a different authorized coach was selected. Confirm the displayed session timezone. Due and overdue work appears in Rep; the daily digest links to work due or awaiting review.

Self-paced study: arrange those same checks with a coach. If there has been no relevant client opportunity, use a new fictional case and mark real-work application as not yet observed.

Keep the first attempt and correction. A useful follow-up asks whether the agent can apply the skill in another case.

References

- Your coach and approved team workflow.